

M A R Y L A N D D H C D

NBW

Neighborhood Business Works

FY 2011 – 2023 · Program Performance Overview

Maryland · Small Business Lending Program

Fernando Matos Cruz

67 Cities

\$118.9M in Funding

4,668 Jobs Created

Program at a Glance

Neighborhood Business Works · FY 2011–2023 · State of Maryland

Total Funding

\$118.9M

Allocated across 13 fiscal years

Projects Funded

307

Across Maryland communities

Cities Reached

67

Unique project locations

Jobs Created

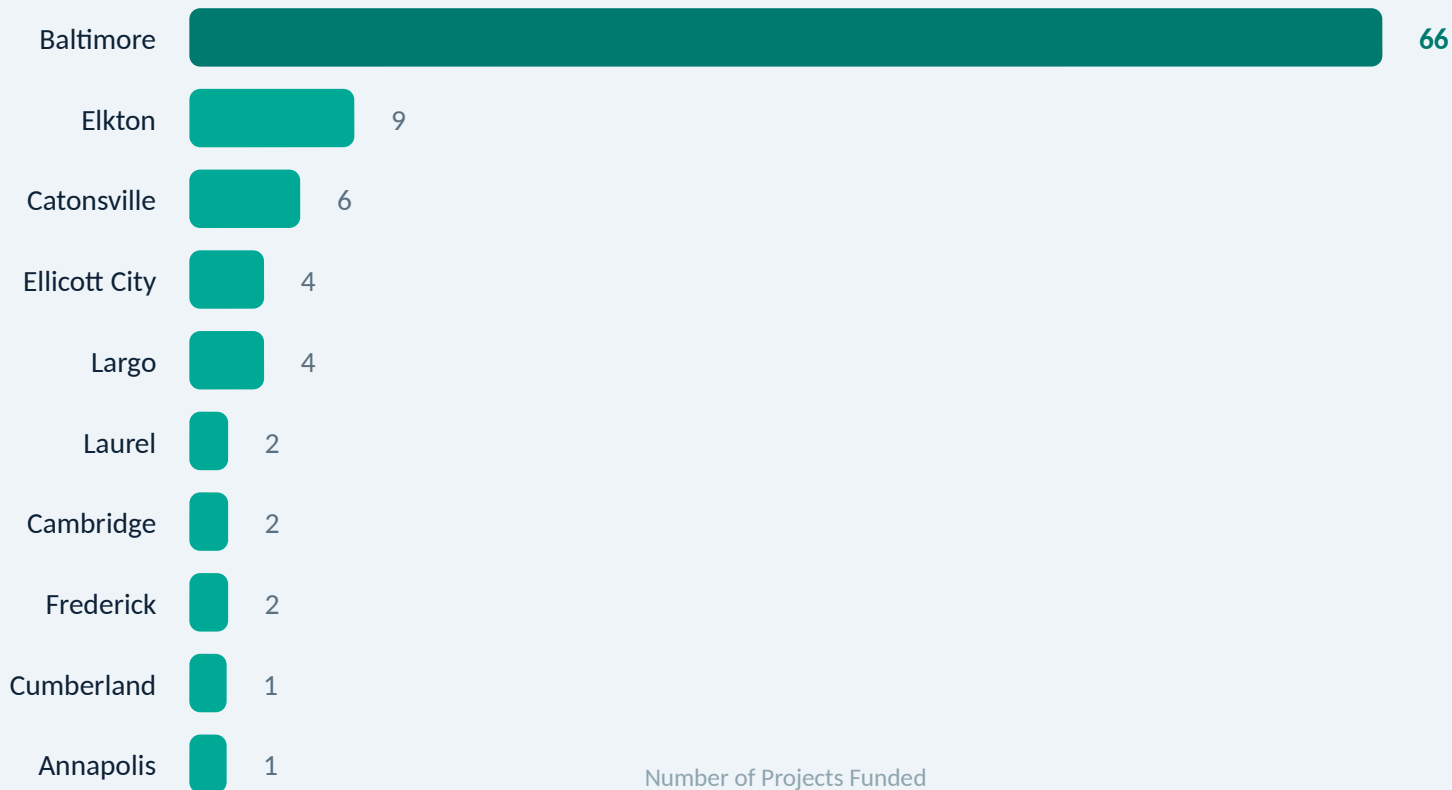
4,668

Direct employment impact

Average grant: \$387,200 · Largest single award: \$15.0M · Smallest award: \$5,000

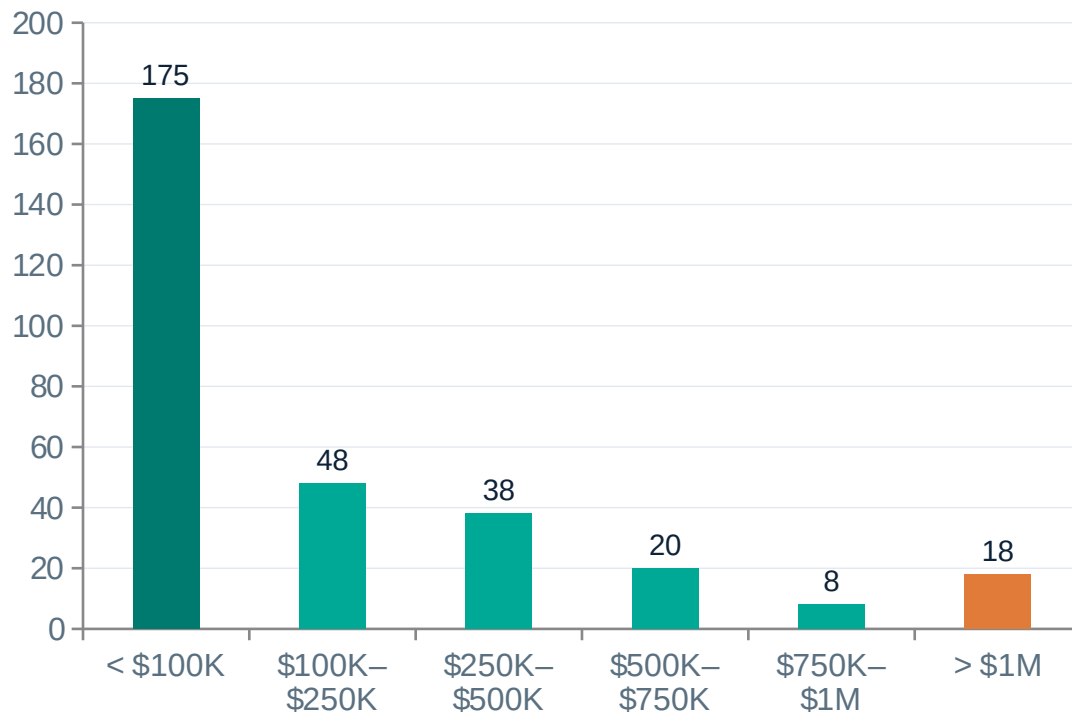
Funding by City

Top 10 cities by total funds allocated · FY 2011–2023



Grant Size Distribution

Number of projects by funding range • FY 2011–2023



57%

of projects
received under \$100K

16%

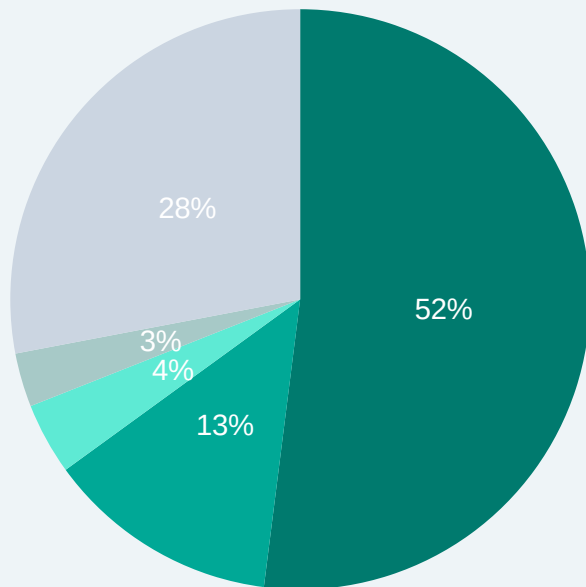
of projects
received between \$100K
and \$250K

6%

of projects
received over \$1M

Employment Impact

Top 8 cities by jobs created through NBW-funded projects



■ Baltimore ■ Elkton ■ Cambridge
■ Bowie / Laurel ■ Other Cities

4,668

Total Jobs Created

52%

Created in Baltimore alone

40%

Of projects reported 0 jobs

38

Average jobs per reporting project

Grant Amount — Statistical Analysis

Descriptive statistics · 307 NBW projects · FY 2011–2023

Statistic	Value
Count (N)	307
Minimum	\$5,000
Maximum	\$15,000,000
Range	\$14,995,000
Total	\$118,870,521.55
Mean	\$387,200.40
Median (50th percentile)	\$87,500
Mode	\$50,000
1st Quartile (Q1 — 25th pct.)	\$40,000
3rd Quartile (Q3 — 75th pct.)	\$350,000
Std. Deviation (Population)	\$1,151,822.11
Std. Deviation (Sample)	\$1,153,702.64

Source: Maryland DHCD · Neighborhood Business Works FY 2011–2023

Mean vs. Median Gap

\$387K mean vs. \$87.5K median

A handful of large grants pull the average far above what a typical recipient receives.

High Dispersion

CV $\approx$ 297%

The standard deviation (\$1.15M) far exceeds the mean, reflecting extreme variation in award sizes.

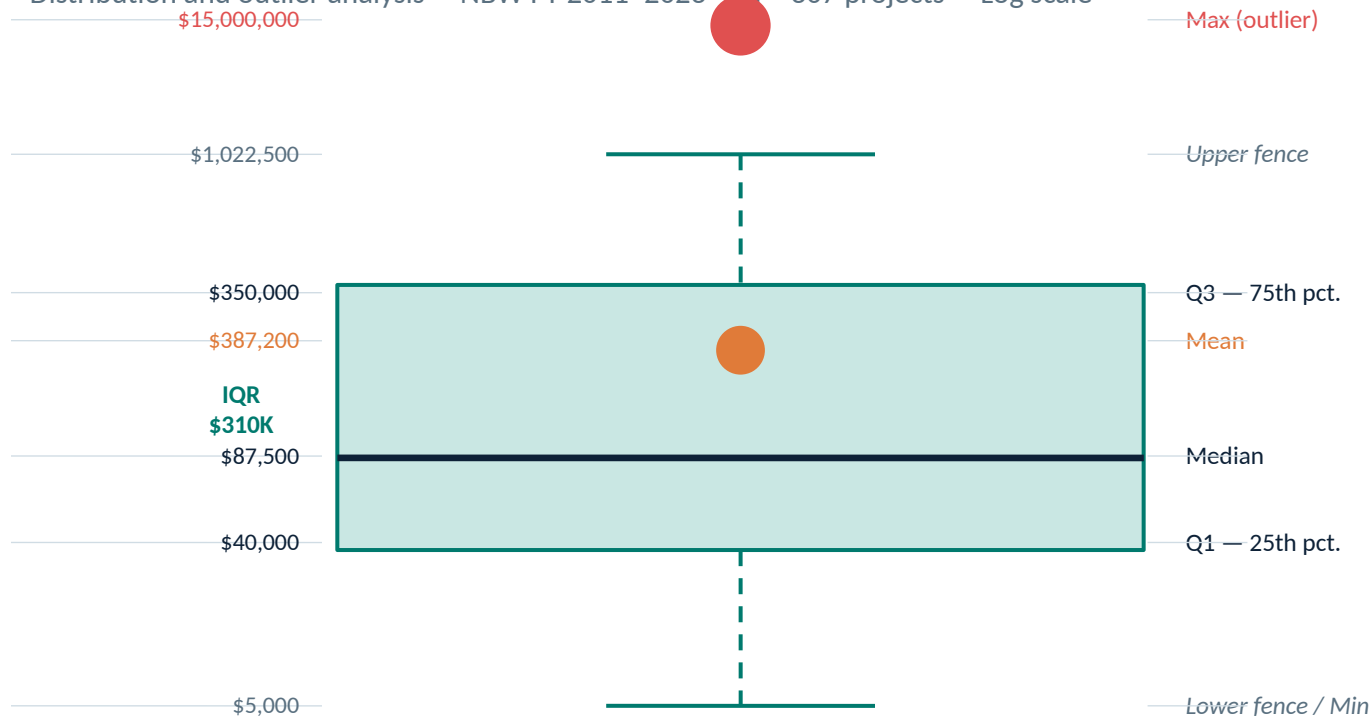
Interquartile Range (IQR)

IQR = \$310,000

Half of all projects received between \$40K (Q1) and \$350K (Q3).

Box & Whisker Plot — Grant Amount

Distribution and outlier analysis • NBW FY 2011–2023 • N = 307 projects • Log scale



Key Insights

What the data tells us · NBW FY 2011–2023

01 Baltimore dominates — and that's a policy signal

Baltimore received 66 of 307 funded projects and 52% of all jobs created. Geographic concentration this deep suggests the program may be underserving rural and suburban Maryland, warranting a more deliberate regional allocation strategy.

02 Most businesses get small grants; a few get transformative ones

57% of awards were under \$100K, yet 18 projects exceeded \$1M. The top grant alone (\$15M) is 3,000× larger than the smallest (\$5K). This extreme spread indicates the program serves two very different borrower profiles within the same framework.

03 The mean is misleading — the median tells the real story

The mean grant of \$387K overstates what a typical business receives. The median is \$87,500 — less than a quarter of the mean. Decision-makers relying on averages risk overestimating program accessibility for the typical applicant.

04

40% of projects reported zero jobs — a tracking gap, not a failure

Nearly half of funded projects recorded no job creation, skewing the employment metric. This likely reflects inconsistent reporting standards, not underperformance. Standardizing outcome tracking would produce a more reliable picture of impact.

05

The program's reach (67 cities) masks unequal depth

Breadth across 67 cities is a strength, but most cities received only 1–2 projects. Sustained impact requires repeat investment in the same communities — single-project cities may not reach the scale needed for lasting economic change.

Neighborhood Business Works

Supporting Maryland's small businesses and communities since 2011

\$118.9M

Total Investment

307

Projects Funded

4,668

Jobs Created

67

Communities Served

Data source: Maryland DHCD · Neighborhood Business Works FY 2011–2023

dhcd.maryland.gov

Created using Excel, statistical analysis, and data visualization.